

Burden budget worksheet

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Worksheet ID:
Timestamp (UTC):
System name:
Revision:
Changelog:

1) System action

- What the system does that can change a person's outcomes.

2) Worst-case error

- Failure mode that matters most.

3) Who experiences harm

- Roles or groups (avoid demographics unless necessary).

4) Forms of burden

- Time | Money | Risk exposure | Humiliation / indignity | Delay | Cognitive load

5) Estimated burden per person (ranges + assumptions)

- Role:
 - Time (min / likely / max):
 - Money (min / likely / max):
 - Delay (min / likely / max):
 - Cognitive load (1–5):
 - Humiliation / indignity (1–5):
 - Risk exposure (1–5 + rationale):
- Assumptions:

6) Who absorbs the burden

- For each burden type, note who absorbs it (user, institution, third party).

7) Maximum acceptable burden (ceiling)

- Time ceiling (hours):
- Money ceiling (USD):
- Delay ceiling (days):
- Ordinal ceiling (1–5 + type):

8) Enforcement trigger

- Threshold condition:
- Mandated action(s):
- Action owner:
- Action timeframe:

9) Repair pathway

- Entry points (links, phone, in-product):
- Required documents:
- Promised turnaround:
- Interim protections:

10) Owner + review cadence

- Accountable owner/team:
- Review cadence: